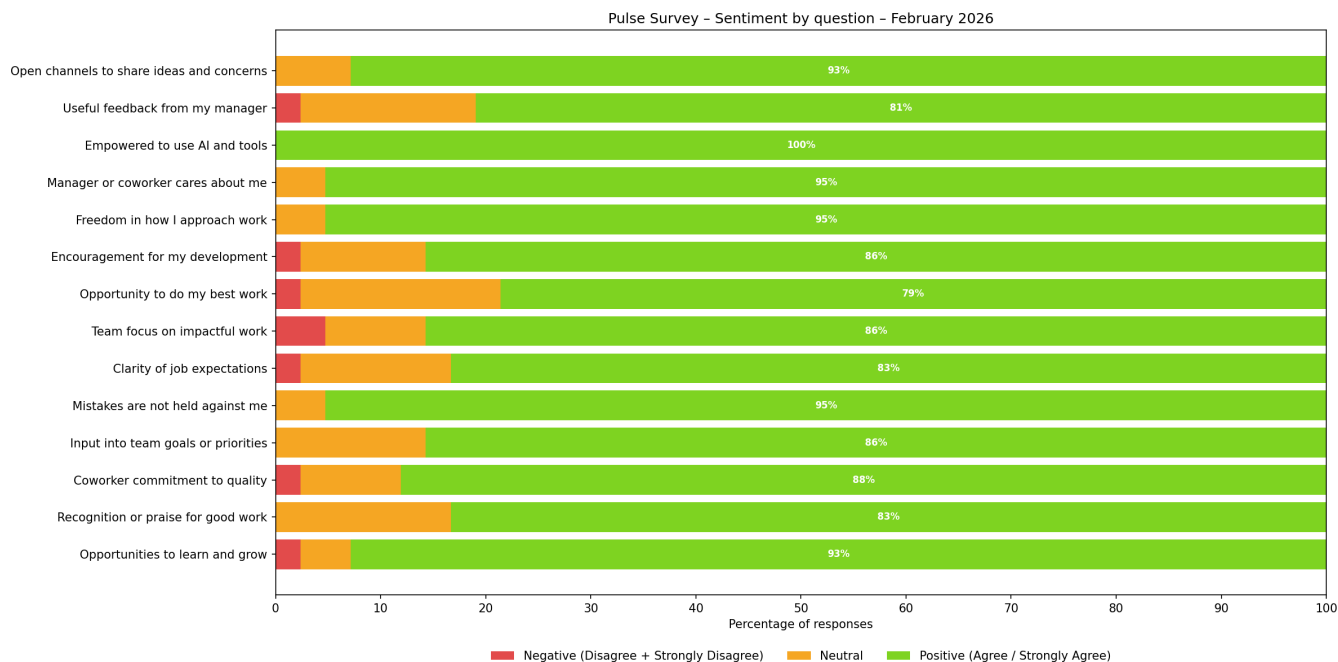
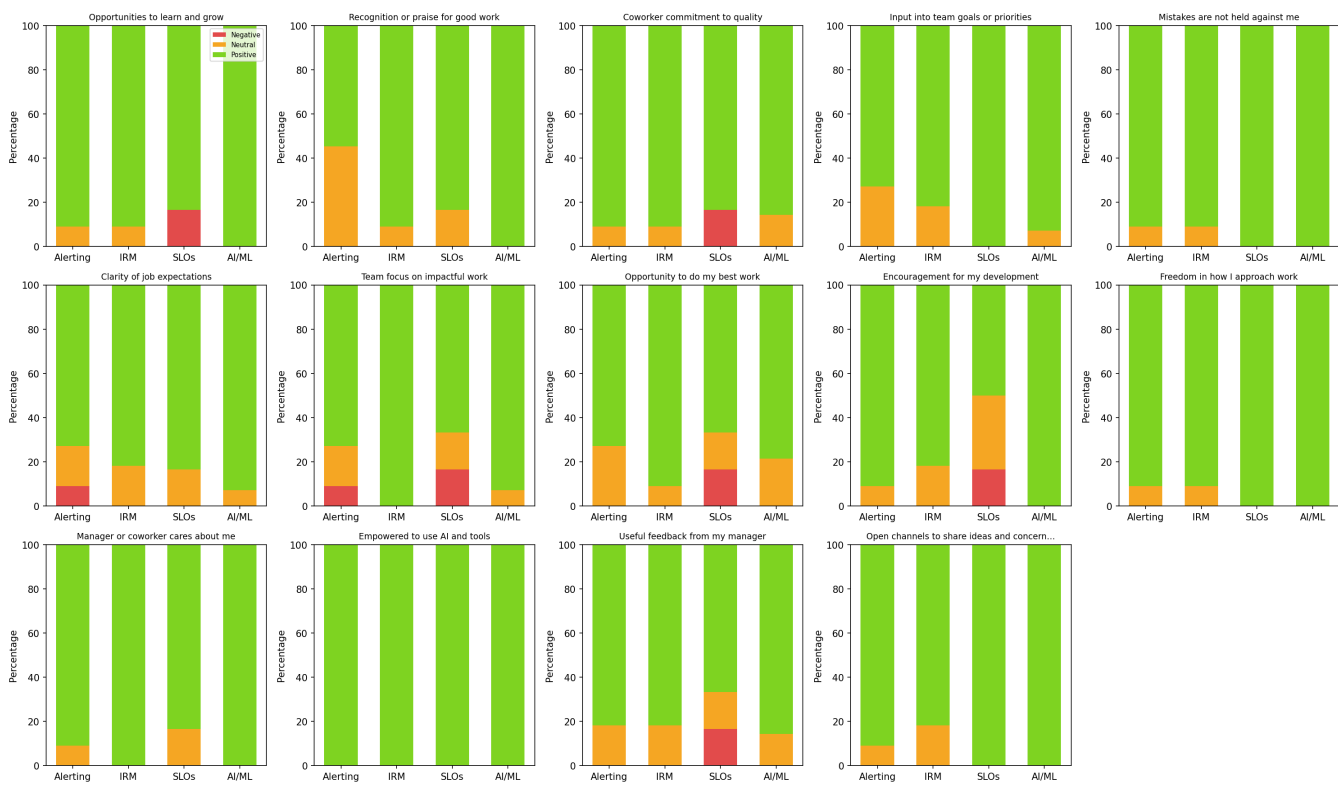


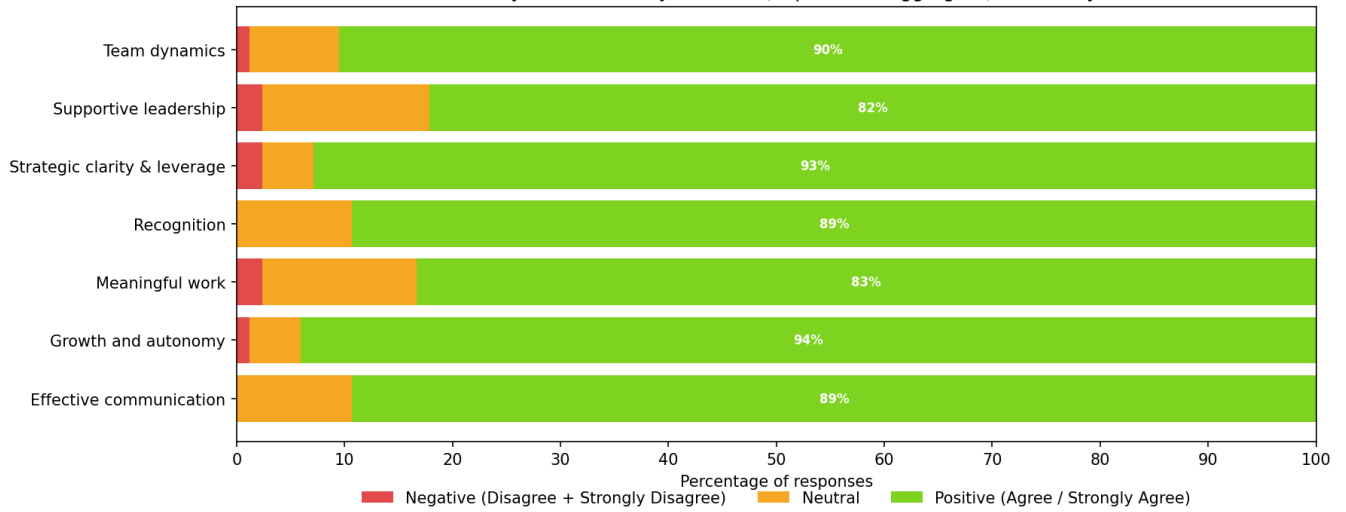
GOps Department Pulse Survey Summary – February 2026



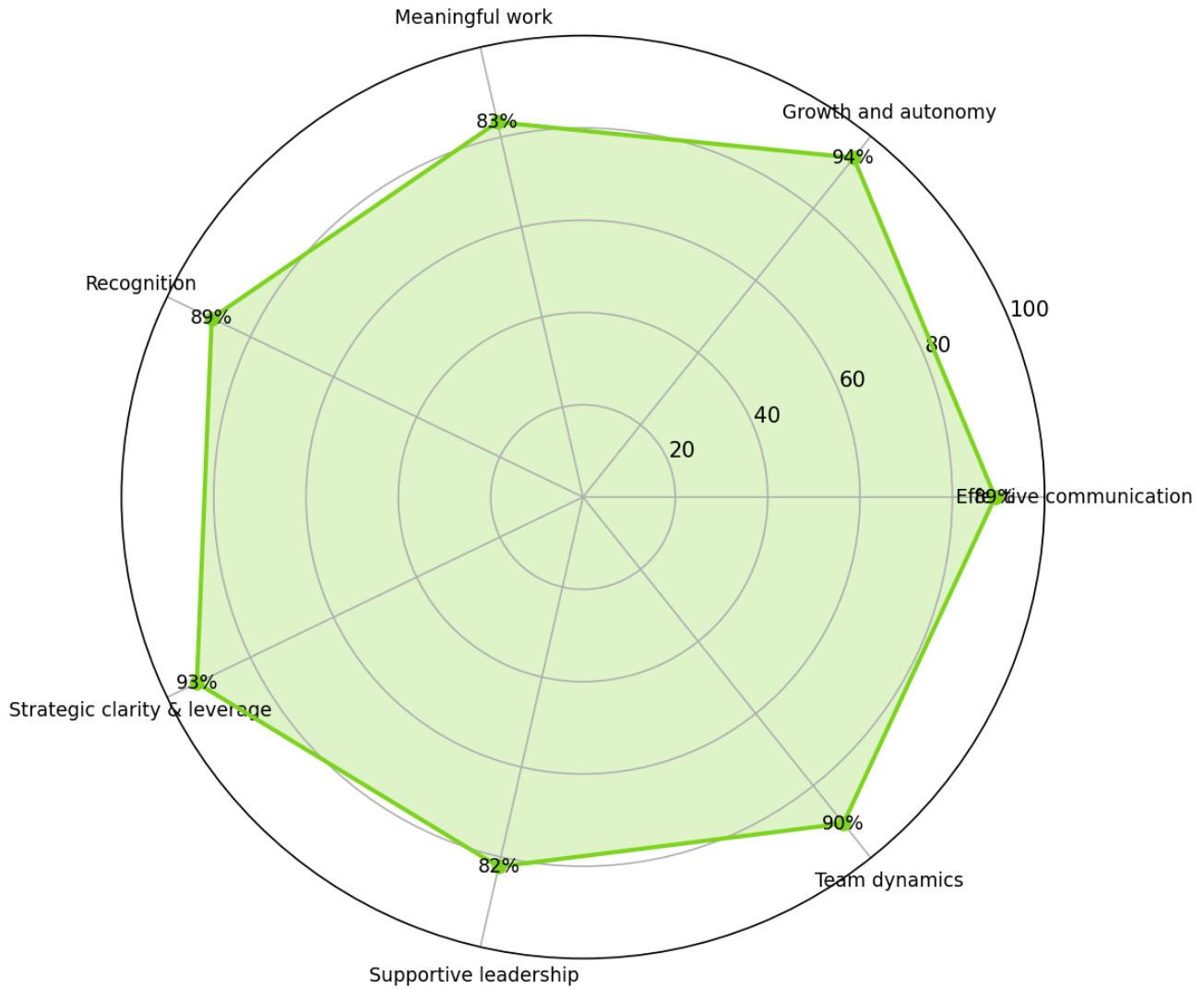
Pulse Survey - Sentiment by question and squad - February 2026



Pulse Survey - Sentiment by attribute (department aggregate) - February 2026



Pulse Survey - Positive % by attribute (radar) - February 2026



Optional comments (grouped by responder rating)

Positive:

1. [AI/ML – Clarity of job expectations, response: Strongly Agree] Maybe it's something at a different level but at this point I kinda have less concrete "expectation", but I get to define and shape the direction
2. [AI/ML – Clarity of job expectations, response: Agree] This is always a hard question. It's probably a good thing this isn't fully fixed, though I'd like to have more input on opportunities I might not be seeing.
3. [AI/ML – Coworker commitment to quality, response: Strongly Agree] A highly motivated team
4. [AI/ML – Coworker commitment to quality, response: Agree] Some more than others, which I suppose is always true but it feels more extreme on both ends here? maybe this is AI's fault!
5. [AI/ML – Empowered to use AI and tools, response: Agree] I do feel empowered; it just does not make much sense to me to see this question as part of the feedback. I see this more as a pressure than as something to "increase my impact and help my team move faster"
6. [AI/ML – Empowered to use AI and tools, response: Agree] It's been tough getting Zed approved for reasons I don't fully understand, and I worry that "what we do" and "what the AI policy says" do not really match up very well.
7. [AI/ML – Mistakes are not held against me, response: Agree] I think it'd get pretty annoying if I were making a ton of mistakes others had to clean up. But we are definitely figuring some things out as we go.
8. [AI/ML – Opportunities to learn and grow, response: Strongly Agree] In AI, there is always something new to learn, it's finding the right thing to focus on which can be difficult.
9. [AI/ML – Recognition or praise for good work, response: Strongly Agree] Yes, both from my manager & team members
10. [AI/ML – Useful feedback from my manager, response: Agree] Could be a bit pushier here, it's fine
11. [Alerting – Empowered to use AI and tools, response: Strongly Agree] I live on a diet of AI and AI enablement.
12. [Alerting – Freedom in how I approach work, response: Strongly Agree] I love the flexibility and autonomy at Grafana, Engineers are trusted to manage our own work which I think really helps with motivation and productivity.
13. [Alerting – Opportunities to learn and grow, response: Strongly Agree] I have a very supportive manager who is invested in my enjoyment of work and opportunities to grow and improve. The work is engaging and challenging, and the whole team are generally very supportive.
14. [Alerting – Team focus on impactful work, response: Agree] Assuming that success looks like AI then yeah.
15. [IRM – Coworker commitment to quality, response: Strongly Agree] Everyone is fully committed, no doubts about this in the IRM department
16. [IRM – Coworker commitment to quality, response: Strongly Agree] People care about one another, want each other to do good work, and put in the time and effort to make things better around them
17. [IRM – Empowered to use AI and tools, response: Strongly Agree] There can't be other answer than Strongly Agree considering the spending limits we have for AI agents. Strongly agree, I appreciate this coming from Grafana
18. [IRM – Empowered to use AI and tools, response: Strongly Agree] i went all in on AI to really see how i can improve with it and i was nearing the budget limit for cursor, and then the budget was increased across the board, and no one has asked me to slow down - that feels very empowering to me
19. [IRM – Encouragement for my development, response: Strongly Agree] Lots of people, our team is very encouraging and supportive
20. [IRM – Encouragement for my development, response: Agree] My manager has been very involved on this front.
21. [IRM – Encouragement for my development, response: Agree] The team and managers are supportive in my work.
22. [IRM – Manager or coworker cares about me, response: Agree] I agree, manager is a very dedicated person towards our 1:1s
23. [IRM – Mistakes are not held against me, response: Agree] I feel like my thoughts on this may not be shared by everyone. While we strive for a blameless (or blame-aware) culture, it feels like folks are often hardest on themselves, especially around incidents.

Have we considered shifting our PIR process to require an outside observer to write the PIR and determine PIR actions? Typically they would review the artifacts, interview responders, and write up the PIR. While it can slow things down a bit, it helps decouple the incident from the follow up work and spreads the load and context around the team.
24. [IRM – Opportunities to learn and grow, response: Strongly Agree] I've had to shift focus from mostly just frontend to lots of infra work and some backend work also.
25. [IRM – Opportunities to learn and grow, response: Strongly Agree] So much AI!

26. [IRM – Opportunities to learn and grow, response: Agree] Sort of cheating since I started about 6 months ago so it's been nothing but learning! But really, I've had opportunities to learn and grow, especially around adopting AI tools and taking on larger projects on IRM.
27. [IRM – Opportunity to do my best work, response: Agree] Sometimes Agree, sometimes it's Strongly Agree, depends on projects mostly. I rated an average between these 2
28. [IRM – Recognition or praise for good work, response: Agree] Important to note that often you have to share what you're working on to get this! Posting in shared channels to celebrate wins is a must.
29. [IRM – Recognition or praise for good work, response: Strongly Agree] i think we handle this well
30. [IRM – Team focus on impactful work, response: Agree] A lot of it is running after customer requests, but there are places to develop as well.
31. [IRM – Team focus on impactful work, response: Agree] we need to be bold and find a way to really make our product shine
i think everyone on the team agrees with this
32. [SLOs – Clarity of job expectations, response: Agree] The staff+ expectations around breadth of impact continue to seem a little bit disjoint with regular cadence of squad work (i.e. hard to say no to enough regular work to have time to find breadth work)
33. [SLOs – Empowered to use AI and tools, response: Strongly Agree] In fact, I wish my coworkers were more comfortable with the tools - the main thing holding back additional uses for coding is out-pacing reviews by my team members.
34. [SLOs – Opportunities to learn and grow, response: Strongly Agree] I can work on AI projects, i'm empowered to increase my skills in my role, i feel the opportunities are out there for me if i want to take them.

Neutral:

1. [AI/ML – Coworker commitment to quality, response: Neutral] In this new age of AIs, I have a feeling that we are considering quantity more than quality.
2. [AI/ML – Coworker commitment to quality, response: Neutral] Mixed. With AI assisted coding, it's changing the way we work. We need to rethink and define how we ensure quality work.
3. [AI/ML – Opportunity to do my best work, response: Neutral] There is a quite a bit of toil/maintenance which I don't think is evenly distributed amongst the team, and I end up spending quite a lot of time fixing or dealing with that rather than creating real value.
4. [Alerting – Freedom in how I approach work, response: Neutral] Freedom is AI, right?
5. [IRM – Clarity of job expectations, response: Neutral] The pull between expert area and venturing to learn new things is sometimes difficult to juggle.
6. [IRM – Clarity of job expectations, response: Neutral] We're building newer tools for the team but we are both constrained by top-down pressure and unable to surface things we think are critical.
7. [IRM – Coworker commitment to quality, response: Neutral] Sometimes it feels to me, that we take one or two short cuts too much.
8. [IRM – Encouragement for my development, response: Neutral] Not someone, but the development budget definitely helps.
9. [IRM – Freedom in how I approach work, response: Neutral] We're being told frequently in channel "IHAC who wants..." or support comes in to go around the processes set up to help coordinate, which is a context switcher. Likewise, we're told "Just put it in AI" way too often as a means to success without understanding what happens after that code is put into prod and has to be maintained.
10. [IRM – Input into team goals or priorities, response: Neutral] I'm new to the team so my input is neutral as I learn more about the domain and priorities.
11. [IRM – Input into team goals or priorities, response: Neutral] We often state things are necessary but then are quickly deprioritized by external pressure
12. [IRM – Mistakes are not held against me, response: Neutral] We don't blame folks. When do we get to discuss how decisions were made? We often skip that part of the mistake.
13. [IRM – Open channels to share ideas and concerns, response: Neutral] With our strong push towards AI it feels to me, that having doubts in this direction, doesn't feel to save any more to voice.
14. [IRM – Opportunities to learn and grow, response: Neutral] We don't make time for green field work very often
15. [IRM – Useful feedback from my manager, response: Neutral] I'm having trouble growing my skills on the team.
16. [SLOs – Team focus on impactful work, response: Neutral] it seems like expectations are changing and we're now expected to have higher velocity while also ensuring our squad work integrates with assistant (i.e. more going on, and expectation to move faster). I think some extra

nuance or clarity around the velocity expectation could help here

Negative:

1. [SLOs – Coworker commitment to quality, response: Disagree] Some members of the team are doing great work, the ones I work closest to are hesitant and afraid to take lead
2. [SLOs – Opportunities to learn and grow, response: Disagree] Putting out fires, having to hand hold junior engineers, constantly having to explain to the rest of the team technical and cultural ramifications of decisions.
3. [SLOs – Team focus on impactful work, response: Disagree] We're changing focus too often and I don't feel that we as a team are driving our product forward. We have lost the engineering driven culture that has been so successful for Grafana.

Additional thoughts:

1. [AI/ML] A final thought that is on my mind but not shared in the form above: work-life balance has not been the same in the last year. At least for me, anxiety, work shifts, pressure, etc has all been growing up.
2. [Alerting] I'd like to better understand the long-term strategy for how Alerting and IRM should integrate. There's already some feature overlap, and I'm concerned that adding new features could create friction unless we define clear boundaries or a clear model for how the two areas should collaborate.
3. [IRM] The mantra of "Go faster, use AI" as a repetition in meetings and syncs from folks who aren't using AI frequently feels frustrating. Everyone's already doing it, but it feels like continuous pressure of "just go faster" instead of understanding why we can't or what blockers we face that AI likely can't solve. Similarly, we're seeing more and more contributors outside of the team submitting PRs generated by AI to subvert the design process, shifting the work onto us to review and maintain.

Analysis

5 things working well

1. **Opportunities to learn and grow:** 93% positive sentiment indicates that employees feel they have strong opportunities for development.
2. **Freedom in how I approach work:** 95% positive responses show employees feel empowered to choose their work methods.
3. **Empowered to use AI and tools:** 100% positive sentiment highlights universal satisfaction with access to technology and tools.
4. **Open channels to share ideas and concerns:** 93% positive responses suggest employees feel comfortable voicing opinions and concerns.
5. **Coworker commitment to quality:** 88% positive sentiment reflects a strong team focus on delivering high-quality work.

5 areas for improvement

1. **Useful feedback from my manager:** With 17% neutral and only 81% positive, there is room to enhance the quality and frequency of feedback from managers.
2. **Recognition or praise for good work:** 17% neutral responses indicate some employees may not feel adequately recognized for their contributions.
3. **Clarity of job expectations:** 14% neutral and 2% negative responses suggest some employees may benefit from clearer communication about their roles.
4. **Opportunity to do my best work:** 19% neutral responses show that not all employees consistently feel enabled to perform at their highest level.

5. **Supportive leadership:** With 15% neutral and 2% negative, leadership could further strengthen support and engagement with team members.